This decision-making process is known as the *request pipeline*. In an ASP.NET Core application, the request pipeline comprises a series of software components, each with its own individual responsibility. Some of these components act on the request on its way into the application, and others operate on the response returned by the application. Some might do both. The individual components that perform these functions are known as *middleware*.

Figure 2.12 illustrates this concept, showing a request coming in from the web server and then being passed through a pipeline of several middleware components before reaching the actual application itself, labeled *Razor Pages*.

